1 Project Summary

Larkspur Observatory received a grant of $1,125,000 from the Highland Science Trust on 4 March 2022. The grant identifier is HST-LK-2022-077. The awards desk copies the identifier onto the transmittal and checks every character before filing. Reviewers read the identifier aloud and match it to the award letter. The same transmittal checklist is used for every award: copy the identifier, read it aloud, and file the letter. The principal offices for the study are in Tucson, Arizona, and Flagstaff, Arizona. Larkspur Observatory measures night-sky clarity for public agencies and is based in Tucson.

2 Field Equipment

Red Mesa Instruments, located in Flagstaff, provided equipment worth $318,000 on 18 June 2022. The equipment included mirror kits and weather stations shipped from Flagstaff to Tucson. Field crews trained in Tucson before departure. Red Mesa Instruments remained the equipment vendor for the full study period.

3 Field Season

The Tucson highland study finished on 2 September 2023, when the last instrument was brought home to Flagstaff. Crews of Larkspur Observatory returned to Tucson on 8 September 2023. No station was left on the highland after that recovery. Spare kits were stored in Flagstaff.

4 Findings and Closeout

The highland award was sent back to the funder on 19 November 2023, leaving unspent funds of $64,000. The final report was submitted to the Highland Science Trust in Flagstaff on 2 November 2023. Larkspur Observatory presented the findings in Tucson on 2 November 2023. The closeout letter was sent from Tucson.

5 Dome Logs

The dome log desk of Larkspur Observatory in Tucson keeps routine worksheets for section 5. Staff compare the dome log notes with the prior file and correct spelling before filing. A supervisor in Tucson initials the dome log packet and returns it to the archive shelf. Trainees sit with the dome log desk for a short rotation and then go back to their own queue. This dome log note does not restate a published figure from another section of the Larkspur Observatory record. The archive label shows the section title and the office city Tucson. Clerks file the dome log packet under Dome Logs and record the clerk initials on the jacket.

6 Mirror Checks

The mirror card desk of Larkspur Observatory in Tucson keeps routine worksheets for section 6. Staff compare the mirror card notes with the prior file and correct spelling before filing. A supervisor in Tucson initials the mirror card packet and returns it to the archive shelf. Trainees sit with the mirror card desk for a short rotation and then go back to their own queue. This mirror card note does not restate a published figure from another section of the Larkspur Observatory record. The archive label shows the section title and the office city Tucson. Clerks file the mirror card packet under Mirror Checks and record the clerk initials on the jacket.

7 Night Rotas

The rota sheet desk of Larkspur Observatory in Tucson keeps routine worksheets for section 7. Staff compare the rota sheet notes with the prior file and correct spelling before filing. A supervisor in Tucson initials the rota sheet packet and returns it to the archive shelf. Trainees sit with the rota sheet desk for a short rotation and then go back to their own queue. This rota sheet note does not restate a published figure from another section of the Larkspur Observatory record. The archive label shows the section title and the office city Tucson. Clerks file the rota sheet packet under Night Rotas and record the clerk initials on the jacket.

8 Plate Custody

The plate index desk of Larkspur Observatory in Tucson keeps routine worksheets for section 8. Staff compare the plate index notes with the prior file and correct spelling before filing. A supervisor in Tucson initials the plate index packet and returns it to the archive shelf. Trainees sit with the plate index desk for a short rotation and then go back to their own queue. This plate index note does not restate a published figure from another section of the Larkspur Observatory record. The archive label shows the section title and the office city Tucson. Clerks file the plate index packet under Plate Custody and record the clerk initials on the jacket.

9 Shuttle Times

The shuttle board desk of Larkspur Observatory in Tucson keeps routine worksheets for section 9. Staff compare the shuttle board notes with the prior file and correct spelling before filing. A supervisor in Tucson initials the shuttle board packet and returns it to the archive shelf. Trainees sit with the shuttle board desk for a short rotation and then go back to their own queue. This shuttle board note does not restate a published figure from another section of the Larkspur Observatory record. The archive label shows the section title and the office city Tucson. Clerks file the shuttle board packet under Shuttle Times and record the clerk initials on the jacket.

10 Sky Notes

The sky notebook desk of Larkspur Observatory in Tucson keeps routine worksheets for section 10. Staff compare the sky notebook notes with the prior file and correct spelling before filing. A supervisor in Tucson initials the sky notebook packet and returns it to the archive shelf. Trainees sit with the sky notebook desk for a short rotation and then go back to their own queue. This sky notebook note does not restate a published figure from another section of the Larkspur Observatory record. The archive label shows the section title and the office city Tucson. Clerks file the sky notebook packet under Sky Notes and record the clerk initials on the jacket.

11 Power Checks

The power log desk of Larkspur Observatory in Tucson keeps routine worksheets for section 11. Staff compare the power log notes with the prior file and correct spelling before filing. A supervisor in Tucson initials the power log packet and returns it to the archive shelf. Trainees sit with the power log desk for a short rotation and then go back to their own queue. This power log note does not restate a published figure from another section of the Larkspur Observatory record. The archive label shows the section title and the office city Tucson. Clerks file the power log packet under Power Checks and record the clerk initials on the jacket.

12 Filter Sets

The filter box desk of Larkspur Observatory in Tucson keeps routine worksheets for section 12. Staff compare the filter box notes with the prior file and correct spelling before filing. A supervisor in Tucson initials the filter box packet and returns it to the archive shelf. Trainees sit with the filter box desk for a short rotation and then go back to their own queue. This filter box note does not restate a published figure from another section of the Larkspur Observatory record. The archive label shows the section title and the office city Tucson. Clerks file the filter box packet under Filter Sets and record the clerk initials on the jacket.

13 Closeout Binders

The closeout binder desk of Larkspur Observatory in Tucson keeps routine worksheets for section 13. Staff compare the closeout binder notes with the prior file and correct spelling before filing. A supervisor in Tucson initials the closeout binder packet and returns it to the archive shelf. Trainees sit with the closeout binder desk for a short rotation and then go back to their own queue. This closeout binder note does not restate a published figure from another section of the Larkspur Observatory record. The archive label shows the section title and the office city Tucson. Clerks file the closeout binder packet under Closeout Binders and record the clerk initials on the jacket.